

4.1 How many sites will you host and what bandwidth will you need?

If you have ever used content management systems such as WordPress, you'd notice how they offer multi-site configurations giving you the flexibility to control your domains via a single login. You don't have to worry about remembering additional parameters for each account login. The same holds true for a great hosting plan. If you have to login to a separate account each time you want to modify one of your domains, then you're probably not using the right plan meant for you. However, for a simple, mere web presence intended page it doesn't really matter what the service provider has to offer. A social networking web site does need bandwidth, not because of the number of users out there, but simply because of the kind of content uploaded by the users.

After all, user information that is fed into their profile is plain and simple text. There is no sizeable data that causes any bottleneck. However, consider albums including photos and videos that are uploaded and you suddenly feel the need for more bandwidth. A birthday party, New Year's or a trek to the Himalayas and you suddenly have 135 photos uploaded. With comments and likes and what not. These are bound to eat into the available bandwidth. Such a phenomenon may not be regular. You may not reach fully utilisation everyday, but your website needs to be able to handle the kind of traffic during the peak hours in case you are to sustain the business you intend on running.

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The number of websites you, as a reseller, will host is like asking a fruit vendor how much will he sell for the day. Although he needs to have all fruits available so that he can serve all customers that approach him, there is no real guarantee if he will be able to make a profit. These days customers expect the local fruit vendor on a cart to have imported apples and grapes! Customer demand is increasing, and the same goes for web businesses. As a reseller providing web services, you will have to be equipped and be future-proof.

There is always a way between theory and practice. All activities and tasks can be quantified in some way or the other, and so can you run algorithms to manage these tasks. For example, what is an ideal site? Loads of content, relevant content, etc? A Google comes in with a literally blank screen suddenly shoving all those theories and formulae down the drains.

Nevertheless, for the purists, we'll chalk out a path. According to some